

Absolutely — **repeat** is a very useful target because your passage uses it in the sense of **reproducing memorised information in an exam**, while the wider family covers actions happening again, saying someone's words again, repeated events, media broadcasts, academic repetition, and several important related forms.

Word family: **repeat / repeated / repeatedly / repetition / repetitive / repetitively / repeatable / repeatability**

Base word: repeat

Verb forms: repeat, repeats, repeated, repeating

Nouns: repeat, repetition, repeatability

Adjectives: repeated, repetitive, repeatable

Adverbs: repeatedly, repetitively

Useful compounds: repeat customer, repeat order, repeat offender, repeat performance, repeat prescription, repeating decimal

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “Before meeting him, I used to think studying meant memorising facts and **repeating** them in exams.”

Meaning in your passage: **repeat + learned information (已學資料)** — 把記住的内容再次寫出 / 說出

Here, **repeat** means more than simply “do again.”

The speaker means:

> **memorise facts first, then reproduce essentially the same information in an examination without necessarily thinking deeply about it.**

繁體中文：

把之前背熟、記住的資料在考試中再次寫出來，重現所學內容，而不一定涉及深入分析

Natural translation:

> “I used to think studying meant memorising facts and repeating them in exams.”

「我以前一直以為讀書就是**背誦資料**，然後在考試中把那些内容重複寫出來。」

So here:

> **repeat information in an exam = 把背熟的資料再次重現 / 寫出**

1. **repeat + words/information/action (言語 / 資料 / 動作) — 重複 ; 再說 / 再做一次**

This is the core meaning underlying your original sentence.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I used to think studying meant memorising facts and **repeating them in exams**.”

「我以前以為讀書就是背誦資料，然後在考試中**把內容重複寫出來**。」

Practice 2

> “Could you **repeat the question**, please?”

「你可以**再說一次那條問題**嗎？」

Practice 3

> “The teacher **repeated the instructions** so everyone could understand.”

「老師把指示**再說了一次**，讓每個人都能明白。」

****repeat = 把之前已經說、寫、做或表達過的內容再次進行****

2. **repeat + memorised material (記憶內容) — 背出 ; 照樣重述 / 重寫**

This is the contextual branch closest to your passage.

Practice 4

> “The students could **repeat the facts** but could not explain their meaning.”

「學生能夠**把事實背出來 / 重述出來**，卻不能解釋其意義。」

Practice 5

> “Learning is more than simply **repeating memorised answers**.”

「學習不只是**把背熟的答案重複寫出來**。」

****repeat memorised material = 把已記住的內容再次重現，而不一定表示真正理解****

This belongs to the broader “say/write again” meaning, but it is pedagogically important in your passage.

3. **repeat + what someone said (轉述) — 重複別人的話；轉述**

Practice 6

> “Please don’t **repeat what I told you**.”

「請不要把我告訴你的話**再說給別人聽 / 轉述出去**。」

Practice 7

> “He simply **repeated what the teacher had said**.”

「他只是**重述了老師說過的話**。」

repeat what someone said = 把另一個人之前說過的內容再次說出

Depending on context, this can imply:

* simple repetition;

* reporting it to someone else.

4. **repeat after + person (跟讀 / 跟說) — 跟著.....重複**

A very common teaching construction.

Practice 8

> “**Repeat after me**: ‘The past influences the present.’”

「**跟我讀 / 跟我說**：『過去會影響現在。』」

Practice 9

> “The students **repeated the sentence after the teacher**.”

「學生**跟著老師把句子重複了一遍**。」

repeat after someone = 聽到某人說話後，立即照著說同樣的內容

This is especially common in language teaching.

5. ****event/action repeats (事情再次發生) — 重演 ; 再次發生****

Now the subject itself is the event.

Practice 10

> “History does not always ****repeat**** itself in exactly the same way.”

「歷史不一定會以完全相同的方式****重演****。」

Practice 11

> “The same problem ****repeated**** several months later.”

「同樣的問題幾個月後又****再次出現****。」

****repeat = 某件事情在發生過一次之後再次出現****

6. ****pattern/cycle/process repeats (模式 / 循環) — 重複出現 ; 循環****

A useful recurring-pattern use.

Practice 12

> “The pattern ****repeats**** every four lines.”

「這個模式每四行便****重複一次****。」

Practice 13

> “The cycle ****repeats**** every year.”

「這個循環每年都會****重複出現****。」

****repeat = 某種模式、週期或程序按照相同或相似方式再次出現****

This remains part of the “happen again” concept.

7. **repeat + course/class/year (課程 / 年級) — 重讀 ; 重修**

A useful education-specific meaning.

Practice 14

> “He had to **repeat the course** after failing the final exam.”

「他期末考試不合格後，需要**重修這門課程**。」

Practice 15

> “The student was asked to **repeat the year**.”

「那名學生被要求**重讀該學年 / 留級重讀**。」

repeat a course/year = 因未達要求或其他原因，把已修讀過的課程 / 年級重新修讀一次

This is not simply repeating words.

8. **repeat + experiment/test/procedure (實驗 / 測試) — 重新進行 ; 再做一次**

Practice 16

> “The researchers **repeated the experiment** to check the result.”

「研究人員**重新進行實驗**，以確認結果。」

Practice 17

> “The test should be **repeated** next week.”

「這項測試下星期應該**再做一次**。」

repeat an experiment/test = 再次進行同一或相同程序，以確認、比較或取得另一組結果

This is especially common in science and medicine.

9. **repeat + mistake/error (錯誤) — 再犯 ; 重蹈覆轍**

A very common contextual branch.

Practice 18

> “Try not to **repeat the same mistake**.”

「盡量不要**再犯同樣的錯誤**。」

Practice 19

> “The company promised that the error would not be **repeated**.”

「公司承諾同樣的錯誤不會**再次發生**。」

****repeat a mistake = 再次犯下之前已經出現過的同類錯誤****

Natural Chinese is usually:

> ****再犯****

rather than literal 「重複錯誤」.

10. ****a repeat = something happening again (名詞) — 再次發生 ; 重演****

Now ****repeat**** is a noun.

Practice 20

> “Nobody wants a ****repeat**** of last year’s problems.”

「沒有人希望去年的問題****再次重演****。」

Practice 21

> “The team is hoping to avoid a ****repeat**** of its earlier defeat.”

「球隊希望避免早前的失敗****再次發生****。」

****a repeat of something = 某個已發生的情況再次出現****

11. ****a repeat = rebroadcast programme (電視 / 電台) — 重播節目****

A distinct media noun use.

Practice 22

> “Tonight’s programme is a **repeat**.”

「今晚的節目是**重播**。」

Practice 23

> “The channel showed a **repeat** of the documentary.”

「電視頻道**重播**了**那部紀錄片**。」

a repeat — media = 已經播出過的電視 / 電台節目再次播出

Especially common in British English.

American English also often uses:

> **rerun**

for television programmes.

12. **repeat performance** (再次表演 / 再次出現相同表現) — 重演；再次演出

A useful compound.

Practice 24

> “The audience asked for a **repeat performance**.”

「觀眾要求**再次演出**。」

Practice 25

> “Investors are hoping for a repeat performance of last year’s strong results.”

「投資者希望今年能**再次取得去年那樣的優秀表現**。」

repeat performance = 同一表演再次進行；亦可比喻相似的成功 / 表現再次出現

13. **repeated** = happening many times — 反覆的；多次的

This is more than simply the past tense of **repeat**.

Practice 26

> “The student made **repeated attempts** to answer the question.”

「學生**多次嘗試**回答那條問題。」

Practice 27

> “Repeated interruptions made it difficult to concentrate.”

「**接二連三的打擾**令人難以集中精神。」

repeated = 同一或相似事情發生多次，而不是只再次發生一次

14. **repeatedly** = again and again — 反覆地；多次地

Practice 28

> “He **repeatedly** asked the students to explain their reasoning.”

「他**多次 / 反覆地**要求學生解釋自己的推理。」

Practice 29

> “The machine failed **repeatedly**.”

「這部機器**一再發生故障**。」

repeatedly = 某件事情在不同時間多次發生

15. **repetition** = act of saying/doing something again — 重複；反覆

The main noun.

Practice 30

> “Language learning requires some **repetition**.”

「語言學習需要一定程度的**重複練習**。」

Practice 31

> “Too much **repetition** made the lesson boring.”

「過多的**重複**令課堂變得沉悶。」

repetition = 同一內容、動作或形式再次 / 多次出現的行為或現象

16. **repetition** = deliberate repeated wording/sound (寫作 / 修辭) — 重複手法；反覆

A useful language/literature use.

Practice 32

> “The writer uses **repetition** to emphasise the main idea.”

「作者利用**重複修辭手法**來強調主要思想。」

Practice 33

> “The repetition of the word ‘never’ creates a stronger emotional effect.”

「『never』一詞的**反覆出現**加強了情感效果。」

repetition — language/art = 有意重複字詞、聲音、圖像或結構，以產生強調、節奏或其他效果

Same underlying repetition concept, but an important academic context.

17. **repetitive** = involving the same action/content too many times — 重複單調的；反覆而乏味的

A crucial family distinction.

Practice 34

> “The job became boring and **repetitive**.”

「這份工作變得**重複單調、十分乏味**。」

Practice 35

> “The exercise feels **repetitive** after a while.”

「這項練習做久了會令人覺得**重複而沉悶**。」

repetitive = 同一動作、內容或模式反覆出現，通常帶有單調、乏味的負面意味

Important:

> **repeated** ≠ **repetitive**

18. **repetitively** = in a monotonously repeated way — 重複單調地；反覆地

Practice 36

> “The machine moved **repetitively** from side to side.”

「機器**重複而機械式地**左右移動。」

Practice 37

> “He tapped the desk **repetitively** while waiting.”

「他等待時**反覆不停地**敲著桌面。」

repetitively = 以同一方式反覆進行，常帶有機械化 / 單調意味

19. **repeatable** = able to be repeated — 可重複的；可再現的

A very useful scientific/technical adjective.

Practice 38

> “A scientific test should produce **repeatable results**.”

「科學測試應該產生**可以重複得到的結果**。」

Practice 39

> “The process is simple and **repeatable**.”

「這個程序簡單，而且**可以按相同方式重複進行**。」

****repeatable = 某程序、結果或行動能夠再次以相同 / 相近方式進行或獲得的****

20. ****repeatability = ability to produce the same result again — 重複性；再現一致性****

A useful scientific/engineering noun.

Practice 40

> “The researchers tested the ****repeatability**** of the measurement.”

「研究人員測試這項測量的****重複性 / 重複測量一致性****。」

Practice 41

> “Good equipment should provide high ****repeatability****.”

「優良設備應具備高度的****重複測量一致性****。」

****repeatability = 在相同條件下重複程序時，能取得相同 / 非常接近結果的程度****

Register: science / engineering / measurement.

21. ****repeat customer (商業) — 回頭客；再次光顧的顧客****

A very useful business compound.

Practice 42

> “Good service helps create ****repeat customers****.”

「良好的服務有助吸引****回頭客****。」

Practice 43

> “Most of the restaurant’s business comes from ****repeat customers****.”

「這間餐廳大部分生意來自****再次光顧的熟客****。」

****repeat customer = 曾經購買 / 光顧後再次回來消費的顧客****

22. **repeat order/business (商業) — 再次訂購 ; 重複生意**

Practice 44

> “The company received a large **repeat order**.”

「公司收到一張大型的**再次訂購訂單 / 續訂單**。」

Practice 45

> “High product quality encourages **repeat business**.”

「高產品質素有助帶來**顧客再次光顧的生意**。」

repeat order/business = 原有顧客再次購買相同 / 相關產品或服務

23. **repeat offender (法律) — 累犯 ; 慣犯**

A highly useful lexicalized compound.

Practice 46

> “The law imposes heavier penalties on **repeat offenders**.”

「法律對**累犯 / 多次犯罪者**施加較重刑罰。」

Practice 47

> “The programme aims to reduce the number of repeat offenders.”

「這項計劃旨在減少**再次犯罪的人數**。」

repeat offender = 已犯罪 / 違規後又再次犯同類或其他罪行的人

Register: legal / news.

24. **repeat prescription (醫療 ; 英式) — 重複處方 ; 長期藥物續配處方**

Practice 48

> “She requested a **repeat prescription** for her regular medication.”

「她申請了日常藥物的**續配處方 / 重複處方**。」

Practice 49

> “You can order your repeat prescription online.”

「你可以在網上申請**長期藥物續配處方**。」

repeat prescription = 醫生已授權病人可再次取得同一長期藥物的處方

Especially British English.

25. **repeating decimal (數學) — 循環小數**

A useful mathematical compound.

Practice 50

> “One third is written as the **repeating decimal** 0.333...”

「三分之一可以寫成**循環小數** 0.333.....」

Practice 51

> “The digit pattern continues in a repeating decimal.”

「在**循環小數**中，某組數字會不斷重複。」

repeating decimal = 小數部分有一個數字或一組數字無限循環出現的小數

Repeating decimal is especially common in American English; British English often uses **recurring decimal**.

Important distinction: **repeat vs memorise**

This is central to your passage.

memorise

= put information into memory.

repeat

= reproduce it again.

> “Students memorised the facts.”

「學生把資料背熟。」

> “They repeated the facts in the exam.”

「他們在考試中把那些資料再次寫出來。」

Your sentence deliberately contrasts this style of learning with deeper thinking.

Important distinction: **repeat** vs **revise/review**

repeat

= do/say the same thing again.

revise/review

= study or examine something again, often to improve understanding.

A learner can:

> **review** a chapter

without simply:

> **repeating** every sentence.

So repetition and revision are not identical.

Important distinction: **repeat** vs **reproduce**

repeat

broad everyday word:

say/do/happen again.

reproduce

often emphasizes making/copying something again accurately.

In your passage:

> **repeat memorised facts**

is natural.

> **reproduce memorised facts**

is more formal and emphasizes accurately recreating the content.

Important distinction: **repeat vs copy**

copy

= reproduce from an existing source/model.

repeat

= perform/say the same content again.

> “He copied the answer from his classmate.”

= 抄別人的答案。

> “He repeated the memorised answer.”

= 把自己已背熟的答案再次寫出來。

Very different learner implications.

Important distinction: **repeat vs recur**

repeat

very broad and can be transitive:

> repeat a mistake

recur

usually means an event/problem happens again and is intransitive:

> “The problem recurred.”

「問題再次出現。」

You generally do not say:

> *recur a mistake* ❌

Important distinction: **repeat vs repeated vs repetitive**

This is the critical family contrast.

repeat

verb:

> “Repeat the sentence.”

「把句子再說一次。」

repeated

adjective:

> “Repeated mistakes caused problems.”

「多次出現的錯誤造成問題。」

It emphasizes **happening many times**.

repetitive

adjective:

> “The work is repetitive.”

「工作重複單調。」

It emphasizes **too much sameness**, often boring.

So:

> ****repeated questions****

> = 多次出現的問題

> ****repetitive questions****

> = 問題形式 / 內容反覆雷同，令人覺得單調

Not identical.

Important distinction: ****repeatedly vs repetitively****

****repeatedly****

= many times

> “He repeatedly asked the same question.”

「他多次問同一條問題。」

****repetitively****

= in a mechanically/monotonously repetitive manner

> “He moved his hand repetitively.”

「他的手反覆做同一個動作。」

****Repeatedly**** is much more common.

Important distinction: ****repeatable vs repeated****

****repeated****

= it actually happened more than once.

****repeatable****

= it ****can**** be done again.

> “Repeated tests gave similar results.”

= 已經做了多次測試。

> “The test is repeatable.”

= 這項測試能再次按相同方法進行。

Important distinction: **repeatability vs reproducibility**

In science they are related but not always identical.

repeatability

usually emphasizes obtaining consistent results under **the same or very similar conditions**.

reproducibility

often concerns obtaining consistent results when conditions, operators, laboratories, or methods vary, depending on the field.

For general learners:

> **repeatability = 相同條件下重複進行仍能得到一致結果的程度**

is the safest core meaning.

Important distinction: **a repeat vs repetition**

a repeat

often means:

- * another occurrence;

- * rebroadcast programme.

> “a repeat of last year’s problem”

repetition

means the process/act of repeating.

> “Too much repetition is boring.”

So:

****repeat = 一次再次發生的事件****
****repetition = 重複這種行為 / 現象****

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

****repeat words/information/action** = 再說 / 再做 / 重複**
****repeat memorised material** = 把背熟資料再次重現**
****repeat what someone said** = 重述 / 轉述**
****repeat after someone** = 跟讀 / 跟說**
****event repeats** = 再次發生 / 重演**
****pattern/cycle repeats** = 重複出現 / 循環**
****repeat a course/year** = 重讀 / 重修**
****repeat an experiment/test** = 重新進行**
****repeat a mistake** = 再犯**
****a repeat — recurrence** = 再次發生 / 重演**
****a repeat — media** = 重播節目**
****repeat performance** = 再次演出 / 重演相同表現**
****repeated** = 多次發生的**
****repeatedly** = 反覆 / 多次地**
****repetition** = 重複行為 / 反覆**
****repetition — rhetoric** = 重複修辭手法**
****repetitive** = 重複單調的**
****repetitively** = 機械式反覆地**
****repeatable** = 可重複 / 可再現的**
****repeatability** = 重複一致性**
****repeat customer** = 回頭客**
****repeat order/business** = 再次訂購 / 回頭生意**
****repeat offender** = 累犯**
****repeat prescription** = 續配處方**
****repeating decimal** = 循環小數**

I would exclude obscure derivatives and specialist uses beyond these. This family is rich mainly because the basic idea of ****“again”**** develops differently across education, media, science, business, law, and mathematics.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
repeat words/information/action	把之前已說、寫、做或表達過的內容再次進行

repeat memorised material	把之前背熟的資料再次重現 / 寫出，而不一定涉及深入理解	
repeat what someone said	把另一個人之前說過的內容再次說出 / 轉述	
repeat after someone	聽到某人說話後立即照著說相同內容	
event repeats	已經發生過的事件再次出現	
pattern/cycle repeats	某種模式或週期按照相同 / 相似方式再次出現	
repeat a course/year	把已修讀過的課程 / 年級重新修讀	
repeat experiment/test	再次進行同一程序，以確認或比較結果	
repeat a mistake	再次犯下之前已出現過的錯誤	
a repeat — recurrence	某個已發生過的情況再次出現	
a repeat — media	已播出過的節目再次播出	
repeated	同一 / 相似事情實際發生多次的	
repeatedly	某件事情在不同時間一再發生	
repetition	同一內容、動作或形式再次 / 多次出現的行為或現象	
repetitive	同一動作、內容或模式反覆出現，通常令人感到單調乏味的	
repetitively	以機械、單調的方式反覆做同一事情	
repeatable	能夠再次按照相同方式進行或取得相似結果的	
repeatability	在相同條件下重複程序時取得一致結果的程度	
repeat customer	曾經消費後再次回來購買 / 光顧的顧客	
repeat order/business	原有顧客再次購買所形成的訂單 / 生意	
repeat offender	犯罪 / 違規後再次犯事的人；累犯	
repeat prescription	已獲授權可再次取得同一長期藥物的續配處方	
repeating decimal	小數部分有某個數字 / 數字組合無限循環出現的小數	

For your original sentence

> “Before meeting him, I used to think studying meant memorising facts and **repeating them in exams**.”

The exact meaning is:

repeat = 把之前背熟和記住的資料在考試中再次寫出 / 重現，而不一定真正分析或理解它

So:

> **memorising facts and repeating them in exams**

= **「把資料背熟，然後在考試中把那些內容重複寫出來」**

The contrast in the paragraph is important:

> **memorise → remember information**

> **repeat → reproduce that information**

> **think → analyse and understand it**

Mr Chan changed the speaker's view of learning from the first two toward the third.